Task-5 Part A:

Case Study : PHISHING

Phishing is a depictive cybercrime where attackers pose a legitimate entities such as banks ,government agencies or popular online services to trick individuals into revealing sensitive information like usernames ,passwords and financial details.

How It Happens (Step-by-Step)

1. Lure initiation : The attackers sends a fraudulent email or SMS that appears to be from a trusted source such as security alert from major bank.
2. Social Engineering: The message creates a sense of urgency ,claiming the victims account will be suspended unless they “verify” their details immediately.
3. The Hook: The victim clicks a provide link ,which redirects them to a spoofed website that looks identical to the official one .
4. Data Harvesting: The victim enters their login credentials or credit card numbers on the fake website ,which attacker captures in real time .
5. Exploitation: The attacker uses the stolen the data to drain bank accounts ,make unauthorized purchases ,or sell the information on the dark web.

Target Audience

While anyone with an internet connection is a potential target, attackers often focus on elderly individuals less familiar with tech security and employees of large organizations to gain corporate network access.

Consequences

Victims face sever e financial loss, damage credit scores ,and long term stress of identity theft .For business ,a single successful phishing link can lead to massive data breaches and irreparable reputational damage .